

İlkem Burdur

Backend Engineer | Distributed Systems | Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm İlkem, 26 years old, and a 2024 Computer Engineering graduate from Gazi University. I'm a backend-focused software engineer with hands-on experience building Go services, distributed systems, and cloud infrastructure. My experience includes working with Go, gRPC/Protobuf, Kafka, ScyllaDB, Redis, Kubernetes, AWS, CI/CD, and observability tooling. I'm particularly interested in backend architecture, performance engineering, and observability, and I enjoy learning how systems work from first principles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go (primary), Python, C#, JavaScript, SQL

Backend: REST APIs, gRPC/Protobuf, WebSockets, microservices, concurrency, automated testing

Data: PostgreSQL, ScyllaDB, DynamoDB, Redis, SQLite; schema design and query optimization

Cloud / Infra: AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, ArgoCD, secrets management, CI/CD

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Tempo, OpenTelemetry, Sentry, Nagios

Frameworks: Django, ASP.NET Core, WCF, Svelte/SvelteKit, React Native, Next.js

EXPERIENCE

Kreata

Weybridge, United Kingdom — Remote

Co-Founder & Software Engineer

May 2024 – Oct 2025

- Led end-to-end engineering for a multi-platform community product, owning backend architecture, infrastructure, deployment, observability, and product delivery.
- Designed a four-service Go backend using gRPC/Protobuf internally, REST APIs externally, WebSockets for real-time interactions, and Kafka for event-driven workflows.
- Valuated ScyllaDB, Redis, and service performance with simulated workloads of up to 1M users, measuring read/write throughput, latency, and garbage-collection behavior to guide storage and backend decisions.
- Built development/pre-alpha infrastructure with Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, and ArgoCD; implemented CI/CD with CircleCI and end-to-end observability with Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Tempo, OpenTelemetry, Sentry, and Nagios.

Bumper UK

Türkiye — Remote

Software Engineer Intern

Apr 2024 – Jun 2024

- Developed Python/Django backend features and REST APIs; designed PostgreSQL schemas and optimized queries using indexing and query restructuring to reduce latency.
- Implemented automated tests and delivered task-based changes through the team development workflow.

Bromcom

London, United Kingdom — Remote

Associate Software Engineer · Contract

Apr 2019 – Feb 2020

- Developed C#.NET application features in an Agile team and modernized legacy WCF service components toward ASP.NET Core to improve maintainability and reduce coupling.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

AudioFP — Audio Fingerprinting Engine | Go

- Built a Shazam-inspired fingerprinting engine from scratch using WAV processing, FFT/STFT, spectral peak extraction, constellation-map fingerprinting, hashing, and time-alignment voting; benchmarked matching/indexing in the tens-of-milliseconds range.
- Created 87 automated tests across DSP, matching, storage, and API layers and published a technical write-up explaining the implementation.
- Wrote a detailed technical breakdown of the project | [I Built Shazam from Scratch to Understand: How it actually works](#)

go-2fa — TOTP & QR Code Generation Library | Go

- Implemented RFC 6238-compatible TOTP with HMAC-SHA1 and a dependency-free QR pipeline covering encoding, masking, finder patterns, and Reed-Solomon error correction.

Gecko Bot — Multi-Platform Community Management Bot | Go, Docker, REST APIs

- Building integrations for Twitch, Kick, YouTube, Discord, and Trovo using Go, gRPC/Protobuf, REST, WebSockets, Kafka, Redis, ScyllaDB, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, and observability tooling.

AYA / Turkey Earthquake Outreach | PostgreSQL, Microservices · Feb–Mar 2023

- Collaborated within a 300+ volunteer team to deliver NGO-matching features during active disaster response operations.
- Contributed to PostgreSQL-backed microservices handling high-volume volunteer data under real-world load.

EDUCATION & ADDITIONAL

Gazi University

B.Sc. Computer Engineering

Ankara, Türkiye
2020 – 2024

Stanford University — Code in Place

Python Programming & Software Development Fundamentals

Online
Apr – Jun 2023

Languages: Turkish (Native) | English (Working Proficiency) | German (Elementary)